



RED BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident:	14 th November 2022	Time of Incident:	11:40am
Directorate / Region:	GSR	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	SHW Incident injury / illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	29026
Actual Consequence:	Major	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Fingers (left index and middle) caught in brush chipper winch inlet resulting in serious lost time injury.
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What Happened:

A worker was conducting roadside vegetation work for bridge fire risk mitigation using a brush chipper with a combined winch system. Two workers were operating the winch as per manufacturers recommendations. One worker was controlling operation of the winch controls and one was working the winch line and chain choker.

During operation, the winch line loop was retracted beyond the desired length leaving only approximately 50mm available to retrieve from the winch inlet. The worker working the winch line attempted to retrieve the line loop by placing pressure on it using his left index and middle fingers, while the control operator reversed the line. This would prevent losing the line behind the inlet as it may become coiled.

While the winch worker was attempting retrieval of the line loop, the control operator mistakenly pressed the forward button and not the reverse button. Upon doing this, the workers fingers were drawn into the winch inlet causing them to be crushed. This has resulted in an LTI injury.



Stock photo of chipper with winch



Worksite

A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to **Mobile Plant**.

Immediate Actions:

Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):

- All operators are to be familiar with the plant they use, any change requires additional risk mitigation and training
- All operators are to be aware of pinch points on plant, check all warning decals are in place and readable.
- All plant introduced into the workplace should undertake a plant risk assessment to identify hazards

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations